KLP CONSULTING SERVICES

LEADERSHIP DRIFT FIELD TOOLBOX

Printable Operating Frameworks, Matrices & Implementation Guides

Official companion materials for *Leadership Drift* by Kristen Peloquin. Built for executive teams, frontline supervisors, and operations leaders moving from reactive firefighting to scalable execution.

INCLUDED TOOLS:

- Decision Architecture & Rights Matrix
- The Priority Kill Switch Form
- The 1-on-1 Feedback Log (48-Hour Standard)
- The Seam Handoff Standard (Internal SLA)
- The Leadership Behavioral Contract

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TOOL 1 • GOVERNANCE & VELOCITY

Decision Architecture & Rights Matrix

> ***The Rule of the Single "A":*** *There are no consensus votes and no split accountabilities. One person owns the decision ("A"). Peer input is heard ("C"), but the Accountable leader decides. If anyone disagrees, they escalate with a clear recommendation.*

DECISION TIER DEFINITIONS

Tier 1 • Operational: Daily frontline execution within published guardrails. No management permission needed.

Tier 2 • Managerial: Process changes, inter-departmental handoffs, or resource allocations that impact workflow.

Tier 3 • Strategic: High-risk structural shifts, organizational realignments, or critical customer/financial commitments.

DECISION DESCRIPTION & SCOPE	TIER (1-3)	THE SINGLE "A" (ACCOUNTABLE)	CONSULTED ("C") & INFORMED ("I")	PREREQUISITES / WHAT MUST BE TRUE TO DECIDE	TARGET DATE & ESCALATION
Example: Project Intake Prioritization	TIER 2	VP of Operations (Sole owner of stack-rank)	**C:** Engineering Lead, Product Lead **I:** Executive Staff	Capacity audit complete; trade-off identified using Kill Switch.	Every Monday, 9:00 AM *Escalate to CEO if tied*
	[1 / 2 / 3]				
	[1 / 2 / 3]				
	[1 / 2 / 3]				
	[1 / 2 / 3]				

Rollout Standard: Publish this matrix in your department's shared workspace. Review weekly. When a decision stalls, ask: *"Who is the single 'A' in the room?"* Let them make the call.

Department Executive Sign-Off
Date Published & Reinforced

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TOOL 2 • CAPACITY & FOCUS

The Priority Kill Switch Form

> *The One-In, One-Out Rule: You cannot add mass to a full system without removing mass. When the team is at capacity, an existing Priority 1 must be explicitly paused, delayed, or stopped before a new Priority 1 initiative enters the system. If the team has real capacity, the initiative goes on the active list. No hidden carryover. No unspoken expectation that the team will do both.*

PART 1: THE CAPACITY CHECK (DO WE HAVE REAL CAPACITY?)

TEAM / FUNCTION _____ **NUMBER OF ACTIVE PRIORITIES TODAY** _____ **DATE** _____

- ☐ YES: the team has real capacity. Add the initiative to the active priorities list. Parts 2 to 4 are not required.
- ☐ NO: the team is at capacity. A trade-off is required. Complete Parts 2 to 4 before the new work starts.

PART 2: THE NEW PRIORITY (WHAT ENTERS THE SYSTEM)

NEW PRIORITY 1 INITIATIVE TITLE _____ **TARGET COMPLETION DATE** _____

REQUESTING LEADER / EXECUTIVE SPONSOR _____ **IMPACTED DEPARTMENT(S)** _____

WHY THIS WORK MATTERS NOW (STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE)

PART 3: THE TRADE-OFF (WHAT EXITS OR PAUSES)

CURRENT PRIORITY 1 INITIATIVE TO BE PAUSED, DELAYED, OR KILLED _____

ACTION

☐ Paused ☐ Delayed ☐ Killed

CURRENT OWNER OF THAT WORK _____ **NEW PROJECTED CHECKPOINT / RESTART DATE** _____

ACCEPTED RISK (WHAT RISK ARE WE EXPLICITLY ACCEPTING BY PAUSING THIS WORK?)

PART 4: EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY & SIGN-OFF

"By signing below, I acknowledge that the paused work will not remain an unspoken expectation for the team. I accept direct executive accountability for the risk created by this trade-off."

Requesting Leader Signature
Name & Date

Executive Approver / Operations Sponsor
Name & Date

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TOOL 3 • ACCOUNTABILITY & FEEDBACK

The 1-on-1 Feedback Log (48-Hour Standard)

> ***The 48-Hour Feedback Standard:*** *Say the thing early. Feedback must occur within 48 hours of observation while facts are fresh. Focus on the standard, not the personality. Document expectations and establish hard checkpoints so accountability cannot drift.*

PART 1: CONTEXT & PARTICIPANTS

EMPLOYEE NAME: _____

SUPERVISOR / LEADER NAME: _____

CONVERSATION DATE: _____

PART 2: THE CORRECTION (FACTS • STANDARDS • ACTION)

1. THE STANDARD (WHAT DOES GOOD LOOK LIKE IN THIS ROLE OR DELIVERABLE?):

2. THE OBSERVED GAP (WHAT SPECIFICALLY OCCURRED? FACTUAL, NON-DEFENSIVE EVIDENCE):

3. THE EXPECTED CHANGE (WHAT OBSERVABLE BEHAVIOR OR DELIVERABLE MUST CHANGE TOMORROW?):

PART 3: THE CHECKPOINT (CLOSING THE LOOP)

NEXT CHECKPOINT DATE (WHEN WILL PROGRESS BE EVALUATED?): _____

CHECKPOINT OUTCOME:

[ ] Standard Met [ ] In Progress [ ] Escalated

PROGRESS NOTES AT CHECKPOINT:

PART 4: ALIGNMENT & SIGN-OFF

"By signing below, we agree that this is an accurate record of our conversation and documented expectations. Both parties retain a copy."

_____ _____

Employee Signature **Supervisor Signature**
Date Date

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TOOL 4 • CROSS-FUNCTIONAL ALIGNMENT

The Seam Handoff Standard (Internal SLA)

> *The Seam Rule: Friction thrives in undefined handoffs between peer departments. When departments point fingers, do not mediate personal disputes. Draw a hard, contractual boundary line. Define what enters the seam, what criteria must be met, and how misses are resolved.*

PART 1: THE OPERATIONAL SEAM

SENDING TEAM (DEPARTMENT A)

RECEIVING TEAM (DEPARTMENT B)

WORK PRODUCT / DELIVERABLE MOVING ACROSS THE SEAM

PART 2: THE INTAKE STANDARD (ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA)

WHAT MUST BE TRUE FOR DEPARTMENT B TO ACCEPT THE WORK WITHOUT REWORK, DELAY, OR KICKBACK?

- ☐ Required form / fields 100% complete
- ☐ Technical specs & assets attached
- ☐ Budget / stakeholder approval documented
- ☐ Hard customer due date specified

SPECIFIC PREREQUISITE CHECKLIST & REQUIRED ARTIFACTS

PART 3: THE RESPONSE STANDARD (TURNAROUND COMMITMENT)

DEPARTMENT B TURNAROUND TIME (UPON RECEIVING COMPLETE HANDOFF)

ACKNOWLEDGMENT STANDARD (TIME TO CONFIRM RECEIPT)

PART 4: RESOLUTION PROTOCOL WHEN STANDARD IS MISSED

1ST MISS PROTOCOL (RESOLVED DIRECTLY BETWEEN PEER OWNERS WITHIN 24 HRS)

2ND MISS ESCALATION (JOINT ROOT-CAUSE AUTOPSY BEFORE DEPARTMENT HEADS)

PART 5: INTER-DEPARTMENTAL MUTUAL COMMITMENT

Department A Leader Signature
Date

Department B Leader Signature
Date

TOOL 5 • CULTURAL ARCHITECTURE

The Leadership Behavioral Contract

> ***Operating Standard:*** *Systems guide the work, but habits sustain the system. This contract formalizes the six non-negotiable leadership behaviors required to eliminate organizational drift.*

THE 6 CORE LEADERSHIP COMMITMENTS

LEADERSHIP HABIT	THE OPERATING STANDARD	THE SELF-AUDIT TEST
1. Direct Feedback with Respect	Say the hard thing early within 48 hours. No hallway meetings after the meeting.	Does the person know exactly what observable behavior must change tomorrow?
2. Explicit Priorities & Trade-offs	State what is NOT a priority. Enforce the One-In, One-Out Kill Switch.	If everything slipped except one deliverable, does the team know what survives?
3. Process-Driven Autopsies	Diagnose the system, not the person. Fix the root cause, not the quarterly symptom.	What process, intake rule, or handoff broke before the individual failed?
4. Radical Context Transparency	Say what you know, what you don't know, and what might change. No PR spin.	Are people hearing business truths from leadership or through hallway rumors?
5. End-to-End Customer Ownership	Eliminate departmental turf wars. Optimize across seams, not within functional silos.	Would a customer care about our internal excuse, or did we drop the promise?
6. Capacity & Focus Protection	Eliminate spreadsheet heroics. Match incoming workload to realistic frontline capacity.	Are our top performers penalized with infinite work because they are reliable?

LEADERSHIP TEAM PUBLIC SIGN-OFF & ADOPTION

"We, the leadership team, publicly commit to holding one another accountable to these six standards. We will challenge drift constructively and model these behaviors daily."

Leader Name & Title	**Leader Name & Title**	**Leader Name & Title**
Leader Name & Title	**Leader Name & Title**	**Leader Name & Title**

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